Obviously, these had been of no interest to me, but had been accidentally discovered while I tried to locate and lock in the frequencies of important radio news broadcasting stations in which I was interested.

After receiving Gary's call, I remembered that I could access the Delhi police wireless network on my radio. I started monitoring it intermittently for the next three days and even nights. I found that it had three call signs on a single frequency, which sounded like 'Gaff 1, 2, & 3'. Later, my batchmate P.S. Bawa, who had been additional commissioner of police, New Delhi range, before Gautam Kaul, and was at that time posted as IGP Goa, told me that these call signs were actually 'Golf 1, 2 and 3', and were used for messages meant for the police commissioner, joint commissioner and the two additional commissioners in charge of two police ranges, which were Delhi and New Delhi.

In October and November 1984, these posts were manned by Subhash Chander Tandon, Nikhil Kumar (under orders of transfer), Hukam Chand Jatav and Gautam Kaul, respectively. I was horrified by what I heard on this network. I wished I had recorded it. In fact, a whole 'book of shame' could have been written based on the contents of those conversations alone. For me, a person with a police background, listening to the communication on that network was a matter of shame and disgust. Only heartless, ruthless and gutless police officers who could sell their souls for career progression could have spoken in that manner.

What I heard on the police network was also a painful reminder of the Sikh persecution during the regime of Zakaria Khan, governor of Lahore (1726–45). Tormented by the exploits of the Sikhs against his rule, Zakaria Khan had laid down a graded scale of rewards for action against them – a blanket for cutting off a Sikh's hair; ten rupees for information about the whereabouts of a Sikh; fifty rupees for a Sikh scalp. Plunder of Sikh homes was made lawful; giving shelter to Sikhs or withholding information about their movements was made a capital offence.

The first thing which startled me was the information passed on by Chanakyapuri police station staff on duty at the nearby Yashwant Place market, which used to be part of the Chanakya Cinema